

THE REQUIREMENT OWNERSHIP CHECKLIST

Three roles worth separating, and the test for finding a real owner.

"ASK THE BUSINESS."

Which business — Risk, Operations, Compliance, Product?

"Business" is not an owner. It's a group of people who may want very different things.

1 REQUIREMENT OWNER

Accountable for the business behaviour. Can approve a change and stand behind it.

2 REQUIREMENT STEWARD

Keeps the requirement clear and testable. Often the BA — not the decision-maker.

3 DECISION OWNER

Makes the specific call: Risk → risk, Compliance → regulation, Ops → process, Tech → design.

4 THE REAL TEST

If two stakeholders disagree, who makes the final call? Better than "who's involved."

5 KNOWLEDGE ≠ AUTHORITY

An SME says how it works today. The owner says how it should work tomorrow.

6 WATCH FOR CIRCULATION

Not silence — everyone's involved, nobody's deciding. Risk → Ops → Compliance → Risk.

THE 5-MINUTE OWNERSHIP TEST

- ☐ Who can explain why it exists?
- ☐ Who accepts the business outcome?

- ☐ Who can approve a material change?
- ☐ If stakeholders disagree, who makes the final call?

REMEMBER

A requirement doesn't have an owner because a name is next to it in Jira.

It has an owner when someone can say: "This is the behaviour we want, and I'm accountable for that decision."